

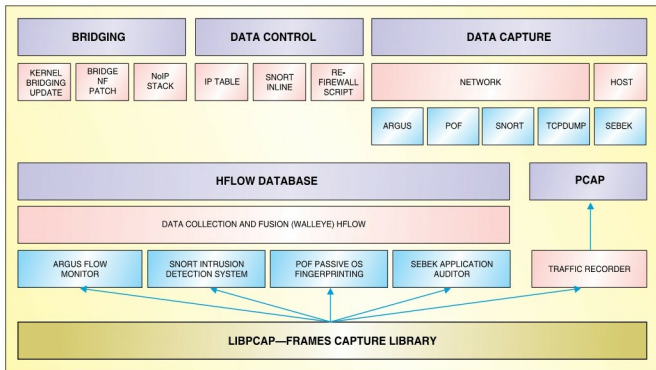


Fig. 2: Honeywall components

ity is gathered. Honeynets are used because no other honeypot solution can gather more information about an attacker. As a high-interaction technology, honeynets gather information not only on attacks but the attackers themselves. Honeynets can gather every information concerning the attackers, from their tools to their keystrokes.

Honeynets are not limited to a single operating system or software solution. According to the requirement, any system (software or hardware) can be placed within the honeynet architecture. Administrators can place a Linux Web server, Windows fileserver or Mac OSX desktop within a honeynet and monitor it. Honeynet architecture has very few limitations. Also, honeynets can create an actual

network. A system administrator can place as many systems as he wants, creating an actual networked environment.

Honeywall

Fig. 1 shows where a honeywall is usually placed in the honeynet architecture. The honeywall can be considered as the main point of entry and exit for all the network traffic for all honeypots. It allows complete control and analysis of all the network traffic to and from a honeynet system.

A honeywall does not have any IP address. Hence it works in hidden mode to the Internet cloud. Most hackers want to know as much as possible about a network, mainly to figure out whether any firewall or intrusion detection system is detecting

their movements. If the honeywall has an IP address, the hacker will know that there is a firewall, intrusion detection system or honeywall in front of the bait systems. In third-generation honeynet architecture, the honeywall works in a bridged environment in which a remote hacker would have no idea that traffic is passing through a honeywall.

Fig. 2 shows the various components of a honeywall:

Data control. Its main purpose is to ensure that the honeywall goes un-noticed and protects rest of the Internet from compromised honeynet 'bait' systems. The challenge is implementing data control while minimising the chance of it getting detected by an attacker or malicious code.



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